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Scan, Skip, or Slam?

Rising Theft, Stressed Staff, and Frustrated Customers — What's Driving It All at Kroger's Self-Checkout?

SELF-CHECKOUT AT A GLANCE

40% of U.S. grocery registers are now Self-checkout

79% of shoppers use it regularly.

HOW PEOPLE REACT

Theft at Self-checkout lanes is **65%** higher than regular checkouts

Even honest customers are tempted when they see no oversight

44% of those who steal admit they'll do it again

What's going wrong?

The Accountability Gap

Self checkout systems are fast, but their design leaves big holes:

- AI alerts lack immediate response.
- Attendants are overwhelmed
- **59%** manage 7+ machines only **37%** feel capable.
- Managers rarely see issues in real time.

Who's on the front line?

"We're severely understaffed. It's unmanageable."

"I had three hours of training before being left alone."

"The software has issues we can't fix without technical support."

Self-Checkout Attendant

My Responsibilities

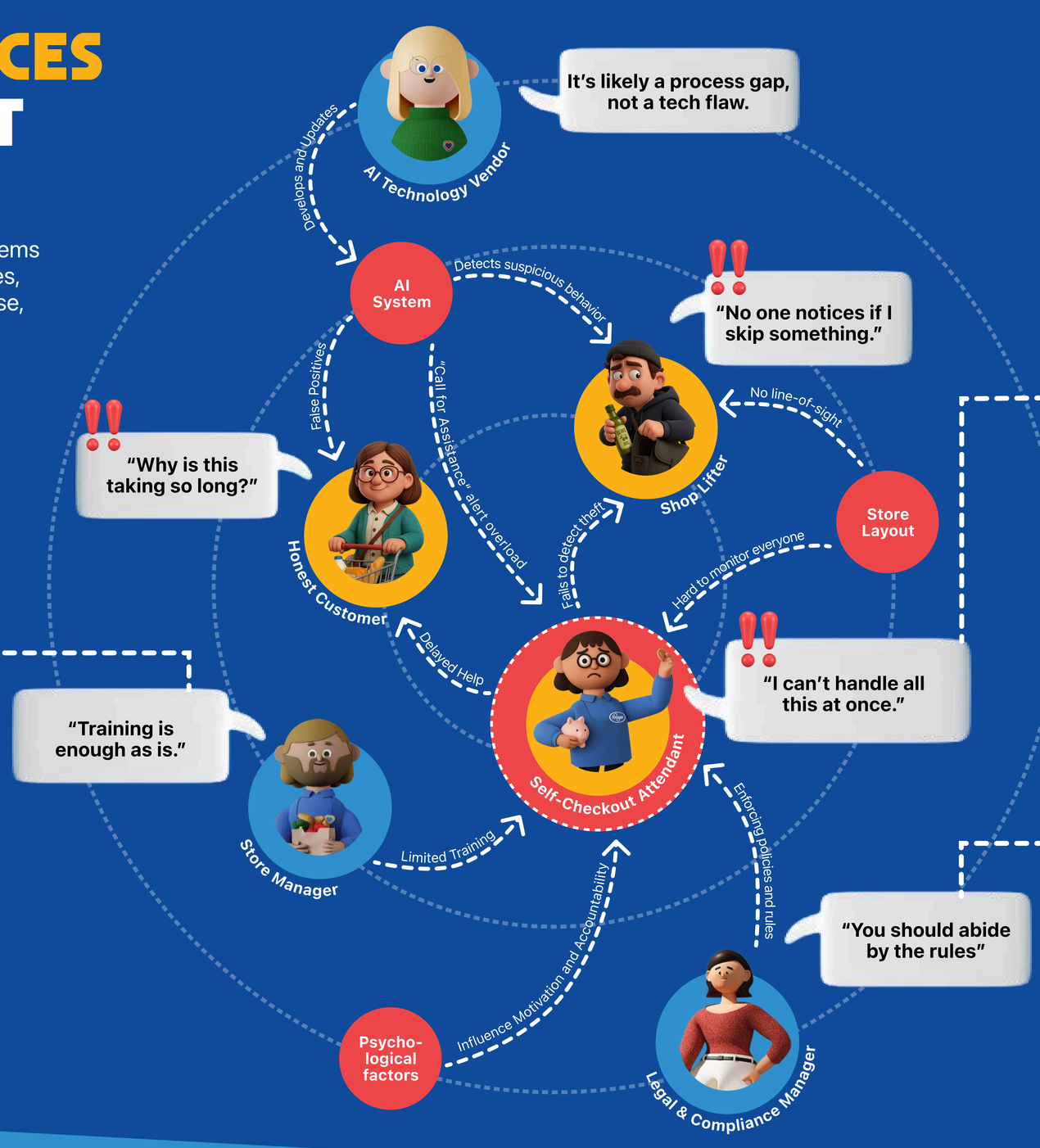
- Monitor self-checkout kiosks
- Assist confused shoppers
- Theft prevention
- Handle machine alerts

Problem Statement

The self-checkout system lacks clear accountability, as theft slips through amid ignored alerts, overloaded attendants, and reactive oversight.

WHAT INFLUENCES SELF-CHECKOUT FAILURE?

The key factors that cause self-checkout systems to underperform include overloaded employees, insufficient training on theft and technology use, and a lack of enforced accountability.



Insufficient Training for Theft & Tech Use — Training Gap

Overloaded Employees at Self-checkout — Operational Gap

No Enforced Accountability — Policy Gap

How might we?

- How might we create **accountability protocols** so attendants and support teams consistently follow through on **alerts, and escalations** in real time?
- How might we leverage AI to **prioritize and route alerts** in ways that reduce attendant overload while **improving response speed** and accuracy?
- How might we **empower attendants** through scenario-based training and **live support tools** so they can confidently manage theft prevention and customer interactions?

Keerthi Ginuga **Navyaa** Taneja
Krishnika Kundu **Siddharth** Madaan